**Gold in Swiss sewers**
Scientists say that $1.8 million worth in gold (43kg) is flushed down Swiss sewers every year.
http://dgit.in/swissg0ld

**Porsche starting a car subscription**
Porsche is starting a car subscription program in Atlanta. The starting price is $2000 per month.
http://dgit.in/porshecarsub

deeper to find out exactly why this system came into being, a solution is readily apparent. With America being a British colony, it made sense for them to continue using the mensuration standards from the homeland, which at that time was the British Imperial System. But as time passed, America DID try to get it's stuff together. One of the Founding Fathers, Thomas Jefferson, actually tried to get the country changed to the Decimal system in 1790. But when push came to shove and he was faced with all the nitty gritties of the system, he was a bit reluctant to steer the rapidly burgeoning nation into switching over.

It's not fair to just blame one person though. France started convincing other nations in Europe and elsewhere to start converting to the metric system. But while France was a monumental driving force behind the Revolutionary War and actually was the reason that America came into being, subsequent repatching between America and Britain (leading to things like the Jay's Treaty in 1795), caused some ill will between France and America. France grew hostile to the new chumminess between the colonies and the motherland and therefore, when it sent out invites for delegates from all the other countries to come ratify the international system of standards, America was conspicuously left out. And it's not like America was anxious to go either. The Secretary of State in 1821 ruled that the current system was good and well established enough and thereby shot down any incentives for change. It wasn't until 1866, when then president Andrew Johnson signed an act stating that it is now "lawful throughout the United States of America to employ the weights and measures of the metric system in all contracts, dealings or court proceedings", that any real traction for converting came around. The next time France held its international convention for deciding on measures, America was invited and formally inducted into the metric system. The International Prototype Metre and the International Prototype Kilogram samples were sent to the US in 1890. Soon, the Mendenhall Order (Named so after the then Superintendent of Weights and Measures) of 1893 states that the fundamental standards for length and weight will be based on the metric system. The Yard got formally stipulated as 3600/3937 meter and the Pound as 0.4535924277 kilogram. But this wasn't enough in and of itself. The aforementioned Mr. Mendenhall, among other eminent scientists strongly advocated for making the metric system compulsory in America. They felt like this was the only way to actually bring about the change definitely. But things remained the way they were for nearly a century more, until 1971. The National Bureau of Standards released a report titled "A Metric America", in which they strongly recommended that America transition over to the metric system completely over the time period of ten years.

The Congress then acted upon this report and passed the Metric Conversion act in 1975 but made a few key changes – the change was made voluntary instead of compulsory and the time period was not defined rather than the stipulated 10 years. School children started learning the SI units, some manufacturers revamped and restructured their processes and machines to make it metric and labs, who apparently used to measure in imperial and convert to metric before publishing results, switched completely over to metric. But the lax requirements of this act meant that there was no real incentive for companies to undergo 'metrification' and the movement fizzled out.

Thomas Corwin Mendenhall was one of the many scientists who strongly advocated for America to go Metric

Today, only an estimated 30% of the products manufactured in America are metric. Since everything is already imperial, conversion to SI units starting from the most basic materials is going to be a prohibitively expensive procedure, both in terms of money and man hours. But just the cost alone wouldn't cause such a big problem. America is naturally a stubborn nation (perhaps due to it's Hegemony) and therefore is resistant to change, especially if that change is foreign in nature. Or perhaps America likes to be hipster. Customers are obviously much more likely to buy products with metric specifications rather than imperial. If America needs to step up it's international market presence, it really does need to make the switch. And it's a slim chance that people do it unless the Congress makes it mandatory and lives with the uncomfortableness and cost for the short amount of years it takes the nation to adjust.

## DRIVING

Have you ever wondered why we are being the hipster ones in this case and drive on the left? Well, blame Britain.

Today, only Britain, and most of it's ex colonies drive on the left, along with Japan and a few other countries. This is due to road traffic developing during feudal times. Since most swordsmen were right handed, they preferred to protect their weaker left side and when mounted on horseback, meet oncoming enemies on their right. Therefore they kept to the left as much as possible. This slowly evolved into a de facto traffic rule and applied to motorized vehicles as well. However, people driving wagons with teams of horses in France and early USA usually sat behind the innermost left horse due to how the wagons were designed. So it made sense for them to keep to their right to see incoming wagons better. And this too, evolved into a traffic rule and due to globalization, spread much more to the other parts of the world.

So why don't we change to the right hand side for complete global standardization? Well... unlike measurements, the direction we drive isn't going affect a lot of things. Added to the fact that most of our infrastructure is built with driving